

adapted itself, as Christianity had to do, to the postponement of the great hope. Saoshyant became a figure of the distant future linked with Zarathushtra by a miraculous birth.¹ The too dogmatic precision of Magian thought ultimately fixed a date for the coming of Saoshyant. According to the Bundahish, as worked out by E. W. West (*SBE*, xlvii. p. xxxi), his birth will take place in 2341 A.D., his two fore-runners dating respectively one and two thousand years before this: the actual Renovation is fixed for 2398 A.D., when Saoshyant reaches the age of fifty-seven. Parsi prediction, wiser than that which even in our own time gains thousands of credulous adherents in Christendom, left a good margin of time before its assertions could be put to the test of experience. *Qui vivra verra!*

As we saw above, Zarathushtra himself concentrates mainly on the individual's future destiny, and the reaction of that destiny on present conduct. 'That men will be judged at last for all their thoughts, words, and deeds, and that their own Self will determine a future destiny of weal or woe, is the sum of his teaching, and it is the sum of Christian teach-

¹ It is not superfluous to remark that this fact has been pressed into comparison with Isai. 7¹⁴ and the story of Matt. 1, and that by Dr P. Horn, a first-rank authority on Iranian subjects. It seems necessary, therefore, to relate the manner of Saoshyant's birth from the seed of Zarathushtra, preserved by 99,999 Fravashis in the waters of Lake *Kāsaoya*, in which at last three maidens successively will be impregnated when bathing, and bring forth severally Saoshyant and his two predecessors, *Uχšyač · arəta* and *Uχšyač · nəmak*. See *SBE*, xxiii. 195 n.² I express no opinion here as to the Matthew story; but surely, in the name of science and sense, we might be spared the trouble of discussing such "parallels" as these!